

LCD Monitor Test



Dream in colour

HP's new GreenColor monitor is the latest thing for colour professionals with a 10-bit, LED-backlit display capable of displaying 1 billion colours



Lynnfeild chipset

Intel's P55 chipsets are due on the 1st of September with support for the yet unseen LGA 1156 CPUs

LG M237WA – SPLIT PERSONALITY?

The LG M237WA was unique from the start. First of all it was the only 23-inch display in test. Secondly, it's a TV and a monitor rolled into one. It's a good looking display, with a thick plastic body that does make it look unnecessarily bulky. The exteriors are well finished with piano black. The power LED is attractive – blue inside a translucent glass that gives a slightly diffused effect. This display has a nice full featured remote control and although a couple of others also had remote units, none had support for a TV cable. That's right – plug in your cable TV wire and you're good to go.

It also has two HDMI ports, composite, component, D-Sub and DVI connects, making it quite an all rounder. The resolution of 1920 x 1080 pixels is also right for an entertainment monitor – this is a cheaper alternative to LCD TVs if you have a gaming console such as the X-Box 360 or the PS3. In terms of performance, the results are mixed. The rendition of red was poor with quite a bit of banding. Green rendition is decent, although there was a lot of banding in the blues in the colour spectrum test. The viewing angles were also an issue, as was the contrast in video clips. It has marginally better horizontal viewing angles than the ASUS 26-inch, but that's not saying much. It does a fair job with games, but really, overall performance is not its forte – features and connectivity are.

Priced at Rs. 17,990, the M237WA is a TN panel based LCD monitor cum TV that should find a pretty wide audience other than the most discerning fraternity, that is.



LG M237WA

impressed us two years ago no longer stands out when compared to the latest crop of displays. In our tests it didn't handle *Crysis* well and the colours look washed out with poorer HDR performance. In the Display Mate intensity tests the contrast was not good. It's good enough for movies but the reds and blues are a bit dull. On a positive note, the brightness level in movies is good, excellent for detailing, and the pixel response is good enough for a satisfactory movie experience.

Samsung's SyncMaster P2250 did well in the grey scale intensity check; in the colour spectrum test the rendition of all the primary colours was good although the ability with blue and green didn't seem as broad – this was surprising, since most monitors do well with green – the most discernable colour. In the 16-shade intensity test the two highest intensities are

pretty close to blending with the others – not good. It did fairly well in the games, particularly *Crysis*, but the performance with videos was pretty mediocre.

ViewSonic's VX2233WM didn't impress us with poor performance in the shade ramp tests and very mediocre performance in the video tests and *Crysis*. In *F.E.A.R.*, the shadows were not realistic at all, and we could spot anomalies. There was also a lot of noise in the darker regions of the screen.

The ASUS VK222H did decently in the colour spectrum test with good rendition of green, but with banding in the transitions from yellow to red and dark blue to light blue. In the grey squares intensity check it didn't do as well as the bigger ASUS VK266H, a poorer measured contrast ratio being the culprit. It's viewing angles are quite poor – a pity for movie junkies. The Intex 2203W performed poorly in the

F.E.A.R test with poor quality shadows, but it wasn't as bad as the Intex 2202TVP that had rusty brown patches in the deepest part of the shadows in *F.E.A.R* – evidently the contrast ratio is not good enough for gaming. Interestingly, this game did not display any other glaring flaws in *Crysis* or other parts of *F.E.A.R.*, but the colours and contrast were not as vivid as we'd like. It's a poor choice for movies as well, so give this one a wide berth.

NEC's 2190UXp does very well in Display Mate in the colour gamut test but there was banding noticeable in the blue segment, especially the transition from blue to cyan. It has an excellent contrast ratio, the benefits of which were most noticeable in movies and *Crysis*, both of which look vivid with startlingly realistic colours. Only the 2690WUXi and 2490WUXi2 did better.

AOC's 2230Fm was the best performer of the company's 22-inch offerings. We loved the way *Crysis* looked, especially for a TN panel – detailed environments and good colour and brightness levels. The sun flare and HDR effects were also excellent, with good detailing on weapons that is not always visible on the lower quality TN panels. We also used the display for playing videos and photos sans a computer – but quality is poor, and although the display itself is good the in-built engine for multimedia playback isn't and it's also picky about the formats used.

The AOC V22 was a surprising let down in Display Mate; we expected more from this WLED panel in terms of colour, but this was not to be. It's fairly good for movies, with good detailing and contrast and does well in games. The AOC F22 also did well in our game tests and

outperforms the AOC 2230Fm in *F.E.A.R.* across all tests except contrast, which is important for enjoying this game. *Crysis* is enjoyable and the viewing angles, while not as good as non-TN panels, are fair.

The AOC 2236Vw was the last of the quartet tested and is a decent monitor with good contrast and colours. Although its performance in Display Mate left something to be desired, especially with the 256-shade ramp test, on the whole it made up for this with the gaming and movie tests.

HP's LE2201w has good viewing angles for a TN panel based display, but little else, its performance in the gaming tests was mediocre at best.

Conclusion

AOC's 2230Fm was the pick of the lot when it comes to sheer value for money. It's got a few additional features, but other than that is a superb display at a good price. Sure you can get better S-PVA panels but then you'd need to spend at least five times more. For Rs. 14,000 it's our Best Buy in the 22-inch category. If you desire pure quality and you must have a 22-inch display (no bigger), then NEC's 2190UXp will satisfy – an S-PVA panel and some excellent scores throughout the slew of tests thrown at it, but it's not cheap and will make you poorer by a good Rs. 75,000. If you desire something really cheap, look

at AOC's 2236Vw, a good all-round performer at an astoundingly low price of Rs. 8,700.



ACER P205H